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Memory Full

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Report content

Explain Situational Theory of Leadership

The **Situational Theory of Leadership** suggests that effective leadership depends on adapting leadership style based on the situation and the readiness (maturity) of the followers. This theory, primarily developed by **Paul Hersey** and **Ken Blanchard**, argues that no single leadership style is best; instead, leaders should adjust their approach depending on the **competence and commitment** of their team members.

Key Components

- Leadership Styles**

Hersey and Blanchard identified four leadership styles that vary based on the level of directive (task-oriented) and supportive (relationship-oriented) behaviors a leader provides:

 - Telling (S1):** High task, low relationship – The leader provides clear instructions and closely supervises work. Suitable for followers who lack skills but are willing to learn.
 - Selling (S2):** High task, high relationship – The leader provides guidance but also encourages and supports employees. Useful for followers who are willing but still need development.
 - Participating (S3):** Low task, high relationship – The leader shares decision-making responsibilities and encourages collaboration. Best for competent but less confident employees.
 - Delegating (S4):** Low task, low relationship – The leader assigns tasks but allows autonomy. Ideal for skilled and motivated employees.
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Followee Readiness (Maturity Levels)

Followers are categorized based on their competence and commitment:

 - M1 (Low readiness):** Lacks skills and motivation → Needs **Telling (S1)**
 - M2 (Some competence, low confidence):** Willing to learn but lacks full ability → Needs **Selling (S2)**
 - M3 (High competence, variable commitment):** Capable but sometimes unsure → Needs **Participating (S3)**
 - M4 (High competence, high commitment):** Fully skilled and motivated → Needs **Delegating (S4)**

Practical Applications

- Business & Management:** Leaders adjust their approach based on employee skills and motivation.
- Education & Training:** Teachers use different strategies based on student understanding.
- Military & Emergency Services:** Commanders shift from directive to delegative styles depending on experience levels.

Conclusion

The Situational Theory of Leadership emphasizes **flexibility** and **adaptability**, making it one of the most practical leadership models. It highlights that leadership effectiveness is not about a one-size-fits-all approach but about **understanding people and adjusting accordingly**.

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ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.

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